# HARIAKSHA GUNDA

**Curriculum Vitae**

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## EDUCATION

**The University of Alabama** — Tuscaloosa, AL
B.S. in Data Science — 08/2022 – 05/2027

- Minors: Mathematics, Computer Science, Economics
- Relevant Coursework: Development Economics, Non-Linear Optimization Theory, Real Analysis I-II, Machine Learning, Database Management Systems
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

**The University of Alabama** — Tuscaloosa, AL
B.A. in Foreign Languages and Literature — 08/2022 – 05/2027

- Concentration: German Language and Literature
- Minors: International Studies, Public Policy Studies, Global and Cultural Perspectives
- Relevant Coursework: Issues in Global Governance, Environmental Decision-Making, International Social Work, American Public Policy
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

## EXPERIENCE

**Research Assistant**, UA Culverhouse College of Business — 01/2024 – Present
**Research Assistant**, The University of Chicago — 06/2026 – 07/2026
**Visiting Researcher**, Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy — 05/2025 - 08/2025
**Data Scientist**, Planet Indonesia International — 12/2024 - 04/2025
**Research Assistant**, UA Digital Forensics and Cyber Security Lab — 08/2023 - 12/2023
**Data Scientist**, Alabama Department of Public Health Center for Health Statistics — 05/2023 - 06/2023

## HONORS AND AWARDS

**Ambassador**, Institute for Economics and Peace — 04/2026 – Present
**Scholarship** (7x, applied each semester), Zeta Psi Educational Foundation — 01/2023 – 03/2026
**REAL List: Global and Intercultural Learning Top 25**, The University of Alabama — 12/2025
**Microsoft Emerging Leader**, Microsoft Security — 04/2025 – Present
**Gilman Scholars Brussels EU Study Tour Selection**, US Department of State — 06/2025
**National Award for Undergraduates of German**, German National Honor Society — 04/2025
**Gilman Research Scholarship**, US Department of State — 12/2024 - 08/2025
**Boren Scholarship**, US Department of Defense — 04/2024 - 04/2025
**Outstanding Cultural Organization**, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club) — 04/2024
**Critical Language Scholarship**, US Department of State (declined) — 03/2024
**Excellence Second-Year**, University of Alabama German Department — 04/2023
**Best Event Award**, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club Mock Shaadi) — 04/2023
**Children of Associates Premier Scholarship** (3x), H&R Block — 09/2022 – 09/2023
**Crimson Scholar**, The University of Alabama — 08/2022 – 05/2024
**National Merit Finalist Scholarship**, National Merit Scholarship Corporation — 04/2022

## PRESENTATIONS

### Oral Presentations

World Congress on Undergraduate Research (WorldCUR), Zayed University, Dubai, United Arab Emirates (accepted). January 2027. *Smoke and Strife: Wind-Instrumented Fire Exposure and Social Conflict in Indonesia*

Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy Brown Bag Seminar. August 2025. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

Planet Indonesia International Intern Symposium. April 2025. *Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces using Data on Ecology and Socio-economic and Environmental Resilience*

State University of Malang Student Seminars. December 2024. *Assessment of Marine Environmental Risks in Indonesia*

### Poster Presentations

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Heat Is On: Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Conflict Probability and Intensity in Indonesia*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. March 2024. *The Impact of Linguistic Features on Revenues using NLP on Mission Statements of Tax-Exempt Organizations*

## CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIAL LEARNING

**Documenting Development Data Using Metadata Standards**, The World Bank Group 08/2026
**Responsible AI in a Global Context**, United Nations University 07/2026
**How Tech Drives Sustainability**, LinkedIn Learning 06/2026
**IEP Ambassador Seminars**, Institute for Economics and Peace 05/2026
**Positive Peace Academy**, Institute for Economics and Peace 02/2026
**Microsoft Emerging Leader Professional Development Series**, Microsoft Security 08/2025
**Climate Catalysts Mentorship Program**, UNFCCC 05/2025
**Becoming a Climate Champion**, UNITAR 04/2025
**Digital4Sustainability Learning Path**, UNSSC 03/2025
**Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification**, DeepLearning.AI 02/2025
**AI For Everyone**, DeepLearning.AI 01/2024
**Cybersecurity Foundations Specialization**, InfoSEC 05/2023
**Python Essential Training**, LinkedIn Learning 11/2022

## PROJECTS

**The University of Alabama** 01/2026 – Present
Principal Investigator *Working Paper*

- Smoke and Strife: Fire Exposure and Social Conflict in Indonesia

**The University of Chicago, The University of Alabama, The University of Toronto** 10/2025 – Present
Research Assistant to Dr. John List, Dr. Michael Price, and Dr. Angela Doku *Working Paper*

- Reading the Storm: Media Attribution of United States Climate Disasters, A Long Panel

**The University of Alabama** 01/2024 – 05/2024
Research Assistant to Dr. Michael Price *No longer active*

- Impact of Mission Statement Linguistic Features on Nonprofit Revenues

**ZEW Mannheim, The University of Alabama** 05/2025 – 08/2025
Research Assistant to Dr. Martin Kesternich and Dr. Michael Price *No longer active*

- The Effects of GDPR on Firm Behavior and Innovation

**Planet Indonesia International** 12/2024 – 04/2025
Data Scientist with Adam Miller *Completed*

- Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces

## EXTRACURRICULARS AND AFFILIATIONS

**Research Ambassador**, UA Office of Undergraduate Research 04/2026 – 05/2027
**Member**, Blue Key Honor Society 04/2026 – Present
**Member**, Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society 04/2026 – Present

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| **Member**, Pi Mu Epsilon, the National Honor Society for Mathematics | 04/2026 – Present |
| **Member**, UA Philomathic Literary Society | 03/2026 – 05/2027 |
| **Member**, UA Education Abroad Alumni Association | 03/2026 – Present |
| **President**, United Nations Association of the USA at UA | 08/2025 – 05/2026 |
| **Technology Mechanisms Working Group Member**, UNFCCC YOUNGO | 06/2025 – Present |
| **Member**, United Nations Association of the USA | 06/2025 – 06/2026 |
| **Member**, Asian Environmental Youth Network | 06/2025 – Present |
| **Data Volunteer**, Oxford Net Zero Tracker | 05/2025 – Present |
| **Member**, Delta Phi Alpha (German National Honor Society) | 05/2024 – Present |
| **Member**, National Security Education Program (NSEP) Alumni Association | 05/2024 – Present |
| **Honors College Ambassador**, UA Honors College | 03/2024 – 05/2027 |
| **Scholarship Officer**, Zeta Psi International Fraternity | 01/2023 – 05/2027 |
| **Member**, Golden Key Honor Society | 09/2022 – Present |
| **Secretary & Advisor**, UA South Asian Culture Club | 08/2022 – 05/2027 |
| **Member**, Association for Computing Machinery | 08/2022 – Present |
| **Member**, Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers | 08/2022 – Present |
| **Member**, UA German Club | 08/2022 – 05/2027 |
| **Choreographer, Teacher, Dancer**, Nach Basanti (Indian fusion dance team) | 08/2022 – 05/2027 |

## FEATURED

### Podcasts

Put the Guidebook Down. April 2026. *Speaking the Place: How Language Changes the Way You Travel*

Put the Guidebook Down. December 2025. *The Power of a Gap Year: Breaking Out of the Linear Life Path*

### Datasets

Oxford Net Zero Tracker. September 2025. *Net Zero Stocktake 2025*

## SKILLS

**Technical Skills:** Python, Econometrics, Field Experiments, R, SQL, MATLAB, TensorFlow, Webscraping, Database Management, Git, HTML/CSS/JS, LaTeX, Stata, QGIS

**Languages:** *German* (CEFR B1: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Indonesian* (ACTFL 2: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Malay* (Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Telugu* (Basic)